China will gain by preserving strategic peace and forging increased mutual dependence. The path towards this, though admittedly difficult, is worthy of pursuit, given the overriding compulsions of both countries.

Speaking at the Shangri-La Dialogue in 2018, Prime Minister Modi's message to China was not of confrontation but to tie the Chinese in rules and conventions of behaviour and offer an alternative philosophy that emphasises the primacy of international law as the cornerstone for developing a security architecture in Asia.[55] Modi emphasised that, like India, China is a most populous country and among the fastest-growing major economies and that the two countries have expanding trade and a multilayered relationship. He added that "strong and stable relations between our two nations are an important factor for global peace and progress."[56]

Although there has been an increasing tempo of investments into India by private Chinese companies in the technology sector, India–China commercial exchanges and investments are still modest. They are also unbalanced. If these economic ties deepen, there will be a greater chance of stability in the bilateral relationship. Economic and institutional integration depend on both parties, not just one. Interdependence between India and China can grow only if underpinned by a greater sense of security. In India's case, this would be furthered by progressively putting in place the third leg of its nuclear weapons triad, extending the range of the Agni Missile and making it more accurate, fully equipping the two newly created mountain divisions of the Indian Army, carrying out defence modernisation, and moving towards a higher level of joint exercises and coordination with friendly navies. In these circumstances, the imperative to cooperate and integrate economically will be greater.

Votaries of closer India–China ties view the growing relationship between India and the United States as undermining India's relations with China, believing that the